

1. Special Measures Extended for Sudanese Nationals in Canada

Canada remains deeply concerned by the ongoing conflict in Sudan and committed to protecting vulnerable people affected by the conflict.

Special measures to support Sudanese nationals already in Canada will be extended beyond October 28, 2025. Eligible individuals can continue to apply for new open work or study permits, or to extend their stay or change their temporary status without paying application fees.

These measures were first introduced in April 2023. By extending these measures, Canada is helping Sudanese nationals remain safely in the country, without the added burden of application fees. This underscores Canada's continued commitment to offering compassionate and practical support to those impacted by global conflict, especially individuals who have already sought safety here.

Canada will continue to stand with the people of Sudan, offering protection and stability through these temporary measures and broader humanitarian efforts.

2025-10-28

[Source](#)

Type : Notice

Region : All

2. Parents and Grandparents Program intake opens in late July

[As announced earlier in 2025](#), Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada (IRCC) will accept up to 10,000 complete applications for sponsorship under the Parents and Grandparents Program this year. Starting on **July 28, 2025**, and over the course of approximately two weeks, IRCC will send invitations to apply to interested potential sponsors.

Anyone who submitted an interest to sponsor form in 2020 but has not yet received an invitation to apply is encouraged to check the email account they provided in 2020. They should make sure to check their junk and spam folders.

Due to the number of forms remaining in the pool of interest to sponsor submissions from 2020, IRCC will send invitations to apply to potential sponsors from that pool instead of opening a new interest to sponsor form.

Those invited to apply as part of the 2025 intake can submit their applications electronically through the [Permanent Residence Portal](#) or the [Representative Permanent Residence Portal](#).

Those who are not invited this year may consider having their parents or grandparents apply for a [super visa](#), which is a multiple-entry visa that is valid for up to 10 years. Super visa holders can stay in Canada for 5 years at a time, with the option to extend their visit by up to two years at a time without leaving the country.

For information on previous application intakes for the Parents and Grandparents Program, see the recently published intake report on our website, [The Parents and Grandparents Program: Intake Report 2020 to 2022](#).

2025-07-16

[Source](#)

Type: Notice

Region: North America

3. Selection process launched for College of Immigration and Citizenship Consultants board

Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada (IRCC) has launched a new selection process to establish a diverse pool of qualified candidates for future appointments to the board of directors of the College of Immigration and Citizenship Consultants.

The college was established in 2021 to regulate immigration and citizenship consultants nationwide as part of the government's efforts to combat fraud in Canada's immigration system. It protects immigration and citizenship clients by regulating the consultants who represent them, and strengthens the integrity of the immigration consulting profession.

The college is self-regulated and governed by a board of nine directors, five of whom are appointed by the minister of Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship. The other four board members are immigration and citizenship consultants licensed by the college who have been elected by their peers. The Government of Canada announced initial appointments to the board in 2022, with terms renewed for two more years in 2024.

To ensure an appropriate number of qualified candidates for the minister's consideration, we are launching a selection process to build a pool of qualified candidates for future appointments.

The selection process emphasizes openness, transparency, merit and inclusivity to reflect Canada's diversity and uphold high standards of governance. Ideal candidates will bring relevant board experience, a solid understanding of modern corporate governance principles and the ability to interpret legislation and make balanced decisions on complex issues. For more information on the position and details on how to apply, please consult the Notice of Appointment Opportunity.

2025-06-23

[Source](#)

Type: Notice

Region: All

4. Canada extends pilot to support skilled refugees and employers

Canada remains a global leader in refugee resettlement. By welcoming skilled refugees and other displaced people to Canada, the government is helping businesses address labour shortages as well as supporting newcomers as they build their lives and contribute to communities across Canada.

The Economic Mobility Pathways Pilot (EMPP) is Canada's first complementary pathway for refugee labour mobility. These pathways are safe, legal immigration pathways for refugees and persons with similar protection needs outside of, and in addition to, traditional resettlement. The EMPP is an economic immigration pathway that recognizes the human and social capital of refugees and other displaced people with skills and qualifications that meet the needs of Canadian employers.

Since the EMPP's inception, candidates have filled labour market needs across the country in in-demand sectors, including health care (more than 30% of total admissions), construction and food service. From 2019 to the end of March 2025, 970 people have been admitted to Canada.

To continue meeting labour market needs, the Government of Canada is extending the federal stream of the EMPP until December 31, 2025. The annual intake cap for the job offer stream in 2025 is 950 applications. This program helps skilled refugees and vulnerable people apply for permanent residence while supporting employers in critical sectors facing labour market shortages.

The extension will allow more workers in essential sectors such as health care to benefit from the pilot's pathway to permanent residence and continue to contribute to our economy.

The EMPP is part of Canada's broader immigration strategy to promote economic growth, address labour market needs and help newcomers settle in communities across the country.

2025-06-12

[Source](#)

Type: Notice

Region: Circumpolar Regions

5. Better Support for Foreign Nationals Facing Human Trafficking and Family Violence in Canada

Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada is dedicated to protecting victims of human trafficking and family violence. This includes regularly reviewing measures for vulnerable foreign nationals in Canada to identify and remove barriers that may prevent them from accessing support.

Effective today, Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada is improving measures for foreign national victims of human trafficking and family violence. Victims and their dependants in Canada may now receive an initial temporary resident permit (TRP) for at least 12 months, with some exceptions. Additionally, fees for subsequent TRPs, work permits, study permits and biometrics will now be waived.

Since 2006, out-of-status foreign nationals in Canada who are victims of human trafficking have been able to apply for a special TRP (VTIP TRP) for free. This permit gives them temporary immigration status, allows them to apply to work or go to school, and gives them health care coverage through the Interim Federal Health Program.

In 2019, the government introduced a TRP for victims of family violence. This has made it easier for victims to escape their abuser or trafficker without fear of jeopardizing their immigration situation in Canada.

The impacts of human trafficking and family violence have far-reaching repercussions for victims, their families and our communities. These expanded measures will remove more obstacles that may prevent victims from getting support, stabilizing their lives, and accessing the resources and services they need.

2025-02-04

[Source](#)

Type: Notice

Region: All

6. Changes to the pre-removal risk assessment for the Democratic Republic of Congo

Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada (IRCC) is deeply concerned about the current situation in the Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC). Since January of this year, conditions in the country have worsened, with grave human rights abuses, including the execution of children, forced recruitment of minors, systematic sexual violence against women and girls, and the persecution of ethnic groups.

DRC nationals who received a negative final decision on their asylum (refugee) claim from the Immigration and Refugee Board of Canada or the Federal Court between July 5, 2024, and July 4, 2025, may now be eligible to apply for a pre-removal risk assessment (PRRA). If someone's PRRA was refused by IRCC during that time, they may also now be eligible to apply again. The Canada Border Services Agency will advise eligible people from the DRC that they can apply for a PRRA if they are currently subject to an enforceable removal order.

The PRRA process prevents people from being sent back to a country where they face risks like persecution, torture or other harm. In normal circumstances, people must wait 12 months after a negative decision on their asylum claim before they can apply for a PRRA. However, IRCC can waive this waiting period if there is a sudden and significant change in conditions in a claimant's country of origin.

People are responsible for keeping their PRRA application up to date and informing IRCC of any changes to their application. Being eligible to apply for a PRRA does not guarantee that someone will be able to stay in Canada. IRCC officers will continue to decide on each case individually, based on the information provided.

People from the DRC who receive a final negative decision after July 4, 2025, are not eligible to apply for a PRRA for 12 months. This is because any recent changes in the situation in the DRC would have already been considered during their asylum claim or PRRA process.

2025-07-12

[Source](#)

Type: Notice

Region: Europe

7. Government reducing number of temporary residents it allows into Canada

In Canada's 2025 federal budget, the government unveiled a new 2026–2028 Immigration Levels Plan that significantly reduces the number of temporary residents the country intends to admit in the coming years. Under the new plan, temporary resident admissions will be cut from 2026 to 2028. This represents a substantial decrease aimed at slowing the growth of the temporary resident population and easing pressure on housing, health care, schools and other public services.

The government plans to keep permanent resident admissions relatively stable, setting targets of about 380,000 new permanent residents per year from 2026 through 2028, slightly down from the 395,000 target for 2025. Officials characterize this as “stabilizing” rather than drastically cutting permanent immigration, while the sharpest reductions are focused on temporary visas.

A major component of the change is the large reduction in international student permits — with targets for new study permits nearly halved for 2026 compared with 2025 — and fewer temporary work permits planned overall. These cuts are intended to bring the proportion of temporary residents in Canada below about 5 % of the total population by the end of 2027.

The budget also includes measures to transition some temporary residents to permanent status (such as a one-time initiative to help up to 33,000 work permit holders become permanent residents), and funding for foreign credential recognition and recruitment of international researchers. These elements are part of a broader effort to reshape Canada's immigration system to align more closely with labour market and economic needs.

Critics of the plan argue that reducing temporary resident numbers — particularly for international students — could have negative effects on the economy, labour force and university finances, while supporters say these changes are necessary to manage infrastructure pressures and housing challenges.

2026-01-07

Sources [1](#), [2](#) and [3](#)

Type: Article

Region: All

8. The consensus on immigration is crumbling as 8 in 10

Conservatives say too many are coming in: poll

Recent polling shows that opinions about immigration in Canada have shifted sharply, especially among Conservative voters. About eight out of ten people who support the Conservative Party now believe that Canada is admitting too many immigrants, **a much higher rate than among** supporters of other major parties. This reflects a growing divide in how Canadians view immigration — while it used to be an area of broad agreement, it's now becoming more politically polarized.

The change in attitudes comes amid wider national debates over housing affordability, access to services, and economic pressures, with many voters tying these issues to high levels of immigration. Across the country, a significant share of Canadians think the federal government is admitting more newcomers than communities can comfortably absorb, and this sentiment is particularly strong among Conservative supporters.

Political leaders are responding to these shifts. Conservative leader Pierre Poilievre has been vocal about reducing immigration levels and linking them to housing supply and service capacity, framing higher numbers as unsustainable. At the same time, other parties are adjusting their policies too, balancing economic arguments for immigration with rising public concern. These evolving views are shaping broader conversations about Canada's immigration system as the next federal election approaches.

2026-02-04

[Source](#)

Type: Article

Region: Africa

9. What's changing in Quebec's immigration system — and why it's sparking backlash

Québec has ended the Quebec Experience Program (PEQ), which until late 2025 was one of the province's main fast-track paths to permanent residency for temporary foreign workers and international students who had lived and worked or studied in the province. The PEQ officially ceased accepting new applications on Nov. 19, 2025, and although applications already submitted continue to be processed, no new applications are being accepted under either of its two streams (graduates and workers). The province made this change as part of a broader overhaul of its immigration system aimed at reducing overall immigration levels and tightening selection criteria.

In place of the PEQ, Québec is now relying on a points-based Skilled Worker Selection Program (PSTQ) as the primary route for skilled workers to obtain permanent residency. Under the PSTQ, candidates are evaluated on factors such as education, work experience and French language ability, and are invited to apply for a Certificat de sélection du Québec (CSQ) — the provincial selection document needed before applying for permanent residence with the federal government. The PSTQ also emphasizes selecting candidates who are likely to settle outside the Montreal and Laval regions and meet specific labour-market priorities.

The shift away from the PEQ toward the PSTQ has sparked concern and protest among many temporary residents, students and worker advocates. Critics argue that ending the PEQ removes a reliable and well-understood pathway that people had counted on to build their lives in Québec, leaving some long-term residents uncertain about their future. While the government defends the changes as necessary to better control immigration and support integration — especially through stronger French language expectations — the transition has been disruptive for those already navigating Québec's immigration system.

2026-02-07

Sources [1](#), [2](#), and [3](#)

Type: Article

Region: All

10. ICE has offices in 5 Canadian cities. Here's what to know.

The U.S. agency Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) has field offices listed in five Canadian cities — Toronto, Vancouver, Calgary, Montreal and Ottawa — according to the U.S. government's own website. These offices are part of ICE's criminal investigative arm, known as Homeland Security Investigations (HSI), which works internationally to combat transnational crime such as human smuggling, drug trafficking, weapons smuggling and other cross-border criminal activity.

Despite being based in Canada, ICE agents do not have law-enforcement powers on Canadian soil — they cannot make arrests, execute search warrants, or carry firearms within Canada. Their presence is tied to their roles within U.S. embassies and consulates, where they liaise with Canadian law enforcement agencies such as the Royal Canadian Mounted Police (RCMP) and the Canada Border Services Agency (CBSA) to share intelligence and coordinate joint investigations that affect both countries.

The reporting notes that the existence of these offices has sparked public questions and some debate about their purpose and authority, especially given the visibility of immigration enforcement issues generally. However, the core function of ICE in Canada remains one of information sharing and cooperation on international criminal investigations — not independent enforcement of U.S. immigration law within Canada.

2026-02-09

[Source](#)

Type: Article

Region: Latin America and the Caribbean

11. What to expect from Canada's new immigration rules in 2026

In 2026, Canada is planning a major recalibration of its immigration system, focused on lowering the total number of people coming into the country and changing how selection works. Federal immigration targets for permanent residents are being reduced slightly from the earlier years of the 2020s — with around 380,000 new permanent residents expected in 2026 and the same number through 2028, down from about 395,000 in 2025 and far below the 500,000-plus levels seen in recent years. Alongside this, the government has introduced explicit caps on temporary residents, which include international students and temporary workers, to try to manage overall population growth and reduce pressure on housing and services.

The temporary resident numbers are being cut sharply compared with the post-pandemic boom: new temporary resident admissions are projected to fall to the mid-300,000 range in 2026 and subsequent years, after peaking at higher levels in previous years. These caps represent a significant shift because for the first time Canada is setting numerical limits on temporary arrivals, a reflection of government efforts to bring the share of temporary residents down to a lower share of the national population.

The overall strategy behind these changes is to shift from rapid expansion toward what officials describe as a more stable, sustainable immigration system that better aligns with housing capacity, labour market needs and community services. As part of this shift, Canada is emphasizing immigration streams that support economic priorities such as skilled workers, and there are new elements like reserved spaces for Francophone immigrants outside Québec. These adjustments are intended to slow overall population growth while still attracting talent and addressing worker shortages in key sectors.

Political and public reaction has been mixed: some see the reductions as necessary to ease pressures on housing and social infrastructure, while others argue that lowering immigration could harm economic growth or hurt sectors that rely on international talent. These policy changes are shaping up to be a central issue in Canadian politics in 2026. (Based on synthesis of reporting and government Immigration Levels Plan documents.)

2026-01-28

[Source](#)

Type: Analysis

Region: All

12. New rules for processing of study permit applications

Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada (IRCC) updated how it processes study permit applications, especially those involving provincial or territorial attestation letters (PALs/TALs). Under the new rules published on Feb. 6, 2026, students in joint academic programs — where study involves more than one designated learning institution (DLI) or more than one province/territory — now need only a single PAL/TAL, instead of multiple letters for each institution or region. This reduces paperwork and simplifies the application process for many international students.

The updated instructions also fully implement an existing exemption for master's and doctoral students at publicly funded DLIs: these graduate-level students no longer need a PAL/TAL to apply. That aligns with broader federal moves to ease some restrictions for advanced degree candidates, even amid overall caps on international student intake.

Some existing rules remain in force: students applying to restore status still need a PAL/TAL, visiting students (including visiting graduate students) must include one, and students changing programs within the same DLI and study level don't need a new PAL/TAL. IRCC clarified that master's and doctoral programs count as the "same level of study" for this purpose.

All applications received in 2026 must follow these updated processing instructions. Applications received before January 1, 2026 will be handled under the old guidelines. Importantly, application submissions without the required PAL/TAL (when not exempt) won't be accepted and will be returned with fees refunded.

2026-02-06

[Source](#)

Type: Analysis

Region: Indo-Pacific

13. Here's how to expedite the processing of your citizenship application

Processing times for Canadian citizenship applications are currently long — around 13 months on average — but in some exceptional circumstances, you may be able to request expedited (urgent) processing of your application instead of waiting the usual amount of time. This option isn't automatic; it's intended for situations where delays would cause serious hardship or where citizenship is immediately necessary for personal or professional reasons.

Examples of what IRCC may consider “exceptional” include needing Canadian citizenship to secure or keep a job, facing a family emergency that requires travel without access to your current passport, or having won a federal court ruling related to a previous citizenship application. Each request is reviewed on its own merits, and just meeting one of these criteria doesn't guarantee approval — the department still assesses whether the case truly justifies faster handling.

If you want to apply for urgent processing before submitting your citizenship application, the process requires a mail-in submission with your completed application forms, an explanation of your situation, and supporting documents. You must clearly label the envelope “Request Urgent Processing – Grant of Citizenship.” If you've already applied, you can still request expedited handling through an online IRCC web form, including your explanation and evidence. Even with approval, IRCC does not guarantee your application will be completed within a specific timeframe.

2026-02-09

[Source](#)

Type: Analysis

Region: All

14. ITA faster than CEC: Alternatives for international graduates and students in Canada

International students and recent graduates in Canada aren't limited to the Express Entry Canadian Experience Class (CEC) as the only route to permanent residence. Several Provincial Nominee Program (PNP) streams can lead to an Invitation to Apply (ITA) for PR more quickly because many of them have lower or no work-experience requirements compared with CEC, which generally requires at least one year of skilled Canadian work experience. These provincial streams are tied to specific provinces or territories and often focus on attracting and retaining graduates who have studied or secured jobs locally.

For example, Ontario's PNP includes streams for international students that don't require a job offer or work experience in some cases — like the Master's Graduate and PhD Graduate streams — allowing eligible graduates to enter the candidate pool soon after finishing their degrees. Other provinces such as Manitoba offer pathways like the Graduate Internship Pathway that require no job offer at all, while Alberta, Nova Scotia, Prince Edward Island and Newfoundland and Labrador each have streams that let graduates submit expressions of interest once they meet local eligibility conditions (such as job offers or residency in the province).

These alternatives can be strategically helpful for graduates whose profile under the CEC system might take longer to generate an ITA due to factors like Comprehensive Ranking System (CRS) score competition. By securing a provincial nomination first, candidates often gain a stronger route to PR either through direct nomination or by boosting their chances under Express Entry with additional nomination points. As a result, planning around provincial pathways can shorten the timeline to permanent residency compared with relying solely on CEC.

2026-02-07

[Source](#)

Type: Opinion

Region: Middle East and North Africa

15. New Express Entry Draw On February 6 Sent 8,500 PR Invitations

Canada's Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada (IRCC) held a major Express Entry draw on February 6, 2026, issuing 8,500 Invitations to Apply (ITAs) for permanent residence. This round was a French-language proficiency category draw, one of the largest of its type in Express Entry history, and it had a Comprehensive Ranking System (CRS) cutoff of 400 points, which is relatively accessible compared with many other rounds this year.

Earlier in the month, IRCC also conducted a draw on February 3, 2026 that targeted the Provincial Nominee Program (PNP), issuing 423 ITAs at a much higher CRS cutoff of 749 points, reflecting the added points that come with a provincial nomination.

The focus of these draws shows IRCC's ongoing strategy to prioritize candidates already in Canada or those with specific skills such as strong French language ability, which supports broader goals around francophone immigration outside Quebec and meeting annual immigration targets. Across the first part of 2026, Canada has continued using multiple Express Entry categories — including Canadian Experience Class, PNP and French-language rounds — to issue tens of thousands of ITAs.

2026-02-01

[Source](#)

Type: Opinion

Region: All